

# Modern Clipboard — Quick Start Guide

Version 1.2

## Step 1 — The Menu Bar Icon

Modern Clipboard runs as a menu bar application. After it launches, its icon appears in the menu bar at the top-right of the screen. The app has no Dock icon; all functions are accessed from the menu bar icon and the keyboard shortcuts described in this guide.

**Note:** Modern Clipboard is configured to launch automatically at login. To disable this, open **Preferences** → **General** and turn off **Launch Modern Clipboard at login**.

## Step 2 — Grant Accessibility Permission

Modern Clipboard needs Accessibility permission to paste on your behalf.

When prompted, click **Open Accessibility Settings** → find **Modern Clipboard** → toggle it **on**.

*Missed the prompt? Open the menu bar icon → **Preferences** → **General** → click **Open Accessibility Settings**.*

## Step 3 — Copy Something

Copy any text as you normally would (⌘C, i.e. Command-C). Modern Clipboard captures it automatically — no action needed.

## Step 4 — Paste from History

Press ⇧⌘V (Shift-Command-V) from anywhere to open the history popup.

| Key          | What it does             |
|--------------|--------------------------|
| ↓ / ↑        | Move between items       |
| → / ←        | Open a folder · go back  |
| ↵ (Return)   | Paste the selected item  |
| 1 – 9        | Instantly paste item 1–9 |
| Esc (Escape) | Close without pasting    |

The popup closes and pastes into whatever app you were using.

**Tip:** Copied formatting (bold, links, colors) is always preserved and pasted back by default. Want it to match the destination's existing style instead? Hold ⌘ **Option** (configurable) while pasting from the popup — this pastes plain text that takes on the formatting already in place where you're pasting.

## Step 4.5 — Clear Your History

Want to wipe everything you've copied? Open **Preferences** → **General**, then click **Clear Clipboard History...** in the Clipboard History section to remove all saved items at once.

## Step 5 — Create a Snippet

Snippets are text blocks you save once and reuse forever — great for signatures, templates, or common replies.

1. Press **⇧⌘S** (Shift-Command-S) to open the snippets popup.
2. Click **Edit Snippets...** below the folder list to open the snippet editor.
3. Click **+** in the left column to create a folder.
4. Select your folder, then click **+** in the middle column to add a snippet.
5. Enter a title and your text, then click **Save**.

Press **⇧⌘S** (Shift-Command-S) anywhere to open your snippets and paste one.

## Step 6 — Quick Snippets (Paste with One Key)

At the top of your snippets you'll find a special ⚡ **Quick Snippets** folder. It holds up to **10** snippets, each mapped to a number key so you can paste it the instant the popup opens — no arrow keys, no clicking.

When you press **⇧⌘S**, the Quick Snippets folder opens automatically. Just press the number next to a snippet to paste it:

| Key          | Pastes                             |
|--------------|------------------------------------|
| 1 – 9        | Quick Snippet in slots 1 through 9 |
| 0            | Quick Snippet in the 10th slot     |
| ↵ (Return)   | The selected snippet               |
| Esc (Escape) | Close without pasting              |

To set them up, open **Edit Snippets...** and select the ⚡ **Quick Snippets** folder. It comes pre-filled with a few examples — replace them with your own most-used text. Add up to 10; the folder can't be deleted, and slot **10** is always the **0** key.

***Tip:** Prefer that the Quick Snippets folder not open automatically? Turn off **Auto-open Quick Snippets folder** in **Preferences** → **General** (Snippets section). Your other folders are always one arrow-key away.*

## Step 7 — Exclude Sensitive Apps

Keep clipboard contents from password managers and other sensitive apps out of your history entirely.

1. Open **Preferences** → **Exclude Apps**.
2. Click **+** and choose an app, or click **Auto-exclude known password managers** to add common ones (1Password, Bitwarden, LastPass, and more) automatically.
3. Anything copied in an excluded app never enters the clipboard history.

## That's it!

| Action                 | Shortcut |                 |
|------------------------|----------|-----------------|
| Open clipboard history | ⇧⌘V      | Shift-Command-V |
| Open snippets          | ⇧⌘S      | Shift-Command-S |

Ran into a problem or have an idea? Open **Preferences** → **Help** to report a bug, request a feature, or export diagnostics.